OSHA Aerial Lift Checklist (29 CFR 1926.453)

Use before each day's work and whenever the lift is set up, used or moved for travel.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.453

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item is marked Defect, stop the work or keep the lift out of service until it is corrected, and record what was done.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.453: Aerial lifts (Part 1926 Subpart L, Scaffolds) 29 CFR 1926.502(d) and (e): body belt use, referenced in the note to 1926.453(b)(2)(v) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-453-aerial-lifts

SECTION A | Setup, controls and loads

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Daily control test Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(i)	Lift controls tested today before use and found in safe working condition	☐	☐	☐	
2	Authorized operator Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(ii)	The person operating the lift is an authorized person	☐	☐	☐	
3	Upper and lower controls Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(ix)	Personnel-carrier boom platform has platform (upper) controls in or beside the platform within the operator's easy reach, plus lower controls	☐	☐	☐	
4	Lower control override Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(ix)	Lower controls can override the upper controls	☐	☐	☐	
5	Control markings Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(ix)	Every control is plainly marked with its function	☐	☐	☐	
6	Brakes Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(vii)	Brakes set before the lift is used	☐	☐	☐	
7	Outriggers Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(vii)	Where outriggers are used, each one rests on a pad or a solid surface	☐	☐	☐	
8	Wheel chocks on inclines Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(vii)	On an incline, wheel chocks are in place before use where they can be safely installed	☐	☐	☐	
9	Load limits Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(vi)	Workers, tools and materials in the basket and on the boom are within the manufacturer's stated load limits	☐	☐	☐	
10	Insulated portion and modifications Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(xi)	Insulated portion shows no alteration that might reduce its insulating value; any field modification has written certification from the manufacturer or an equivalent entity	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Workers in the basket

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Body belt and lanyard Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(v)	Each worker wears a body belt with a lanyard connected to boom or basket; a body belt is used only for tethering or restraint, not as part of a personal fall arrest system	☐	☐	☐	
12	No tying off outside the lift Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(iii)	No lanyard is attached to an adjacent pole, structure or piece of equipment	☐	☐	☐	
13	Footing in the basket Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(iv)	Workers keep both feet on the basket floor and nobody sits or climbs on the basket edge	☐	☐	☐	
14	No raised work positions Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(iv)	No planks, ladders or other devices used to stand on inside the basket	☐	☐	☐	
15	No climbers Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(x)	Nobody working from the lift is wearing climbers	☐	☐	☐	
16	Use of lower controls Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(ix)	Ground-level controls are operated only with permission from the employee in the lift, or in an emergency	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Moving and travel

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
17	No travel with raised boom and occupied basket Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(viii)	Truck is not driven while the boom is elevated in a working position with workers aboard, unless the equipment is specifically designed for that operation	☐	☐	☐	
18	Boom cradled Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(xii)	Boom(s) inspected and properly cradled before the lift is moved for travel	☐	☐	☐	
19	Outriggers stowed Ref. 1926.453(b)(2)(xii)	Outriggers are in the stowed position before travel	☐	☐	☐	
20	Aerial ladder cab lock Ref. 1926.453(b)(1)	Aerial ladder secured in the lower traveling position by the locking device on top of the truck cab before highway travel	☐	☐	☐	
21	Aerial ladder base device Ref. 1926.453(b)(1)	Manually operated device at the base of the aerial ladder engaged before highway travel	☐	☐	☐	

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DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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